

AHEAD OF THE CURVE

IIM Indore has retained its fifth position with continued focus on placements, international collaborations, and dynamic courses

BY RICHIA SHARMA



WITH AI DISRUPTING industries across sectors, what does the future hold for C-suite executives? IIM-Indore is trying to find the answer—by training management graduates to create a synergy between technology and emotional intelligence.

“The institute uses case-based pedagogy to train students. We give a business case and ask half the students to do it themselves and the other half to use AI tools such as ChatGPT and Gemini. Then we analyse what humans do better and what AI does better. Assuming generative AI delivers better results is not always true, and in some cases, human intervention is needed. Bringing that out in the classroom is important,” says Himanshu Rai, Director of IIM Indore.

Blindly trusting ChatGPT to do the right thing can be counterproductive, says Rai. “In a recruitment interview process, a consultancy company asked candidates to

develop a PPT on leadership training model. The candidates used ChatGPT and were rejected, not because they used AI, but because their creatives showed all white males. The recruiter expected them to have noticed this ‘AI bias’ and correct it.”

As its mission states, the institute aims to be a contextually relevant business school with world-class academic standards to develop socially conscious managers. This strategy has also helped the institute make money as its revenues from executive education have increased six times in the last five years; they crossed ₹100 crore this year. What’s more, all its students were placed in 2025, with a median salary of ₹29.5 lakh per annum.

There are several reasons IIM Indore stands out. The curriculum is designed by an expert committee, also having corporate participation to design courses pertinent to Industry 5.0. Students are encouraged to develop leadership

qualities, emotional intelligence, and resilience, which are essential as businesses face unprecedented change.

“In a digital-first world, technical expertise is essential, but human-centric skills—emotional intelligence, creativity, and critical thinking—are becoming more valuable. Automation and AI have made routine tasks obsolete, yet these technologies cannot replicate uniquely human qualities,” says Rai.

Skilling the faculty is a priority. The institute offers a generous allowance with which they can train themselves across the globe and ensure the availability of high-end computing machines and advanced digital resources.

IIM Indore has also started a diploma in AI-ML, and offers courses on Ethics in AI, and AI and Sustainability, keeping in mind their growing relevance.

“B-schools that focus on skilling students and continue to weed out redundant categories will